

Thursday Nov 20, 2025 6:30-7:30pm

Interview with former CSE 110 Tutor Elaine Chao

- Elaine question: Is the Conductor app replacing Canvas and Gradescope?
 - Tutored for powell for 2 quarters, tutored with griswold for 2 quarters

Powell:

- “There are a lot of things wrong with organization in this class” ~Elaine
- Tutors responsible mainly for **labs**, need to catch students up with javascript
 - Labs get ported over from last year
 - Labs hosted on the Canvas
 - Tutors go through the labs, make sure they still work, and then publish them and set when they are released and when they are due to the students
 - Need to make an FAQ page for the lab, write it on Google docs. Linked on the Canvas page for each lab.
 - Create lab assignment on Gradescope
 - Tutors have freedom on what they cover, have general meetings with Powell.
- Meetings with Powell
 - TAs are handling project-related assignments
 - Any issues, anything we want to cover?
 - Tutors get to hear what projects the teams are doing and any problems. But don't really have oversight.
- Lab hours (9am-6pm)
 - Anyone who needs help can come to the lab and ask for help
 - Don't use autograder system on 110 bc Powell doesn't like it
 - Elaine personally likes the autograder system though
 - Put in your name, question, location and then go find the student when they're ready
 - How many ppl usually come to the lab hours?
 - Around 20 max, but then drops off to 2-3. Around midterms there is a spike of 20-30 people bc they wanna ask about the midterm and getting help on the lab.
 - Usually around 5-10 ish people though.
- Students can also DM on slack if they need help, but tutors don't have OH
 - Students have repetitive questions
- 2024, good amount of students that came to lab hours. 2025, huge drop off. Prob a lot of students using ChatGPT
 - Labs still need to stay since we need some way of teaching them Javascript
 - Ask basic questions about Javascript in the midterms
- Teams do sometimes interact with the tutor
 - Ask questions about bugs
- Attendance
 - When Elaine tutored it was in-class activities (i.e. worksheets) for every lectures that were graded on completion

Issues

- **Spreadsheet** used at the beginning of the quarter to assign teams
 - Not stored anywhere, there is no shared google drive
 - Lab FAQs are stored on the personal google drives/computers
 - Not organized
 - Not a single source of truth!!
- Can't leave any notes for future classes (i.e. you should add these back next quarter, bc there was a strike happening)
 - Just copy the canvas over from the previous quarter
 - Can't see the history of what was changed
 - *Andrew: Maybe a staff-only page for this?*
 - One of the tutors made an autograder for the labs, which is helpful! However they are not stored in the google drive, canvas, etc. So in future quarters, can't use them unless they were a returning tutor (like Elaine was)
- Can't leave notes on Canvas with regards to the students bc they're public!

Griswold:

- Project teams of 6
- Less separation between TAs and tutors
 - Main difference is TAs hold office hours
- Teams don't have assigned TAs
- A lot less support in that class
- Students would mostly go to office hours for help debugging on Android Studio
- ChatGPT is awful at android studio at the time, not sure about now
- Elaine took 110 with Griswold
- They didn't have official slacks between TAs and the teams, they had to do it themselves.
- However, the project and user stories are set for them.

Meeting Notes:

- We have meeting notes for the students, but what about the staff?? Cuz sometimes the staff discusses teams during the weekly meetings between tutors, TAs, Prof.
- They usually just yap during the meetings but don't really take notes

Attendance:

- Andrew Pan
- Audria Montalvo